Remote Work Policy

Northwind Technologies | Version 2.1, effective January 1, 2026 | Owner: Human Resources

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out how remote and hybrid work operates at Northwind Technologies. It applies to all employees whose role can be performed away from a company office, as agreed with their manager.

2. Work Arrangements

Arrangement	Description
Office-based	Works from a Northwind office five days a week. Typical for lab, hardware and facilities roles.
Hybrid (default)	Works in the office at least 2 days per week (Tuesday and Thursday are team anchor days) and remotely the rest of the week.
Fully remote	Works remotely full time. Requires VP approval and is reviewed every 12 months.

New employees work in the office at least 3 days per week during their first 90 days to support onboarding.

3. Core Hours and Availability

Employees must be available and responsive between 10:00 and 15:00 in their team's primary time zone (core hours). Outside core hours, employees may flex their schedule provided they complete their contracted hours and meet team commitments.

Employees should keep their calendar current, set a status in the chat tool, and attend scheduled meetings with camera on where practical.

4. Remote Work Locations and Travel

Remote work is normally performed from the employee's registered home address within the country of employment. Working from another city in the same country for up to 4 weeks per year is allowed with manager notice.

Working from abroad (a 'workation') is allowed for up to 20 working days per calendar year, subject to written approval from the manager and HR at least 4 weeks in advance. Approval depends on local tax, legal and data-protection rules, and may be refused. Employees may not work from sanctioned countries.

5. Equipment and Home Office Allowance

Northwind provides a laptop, charger and a headset to every remote and hybrid employee. Employees receive a one-time home office setup allowance of $500 (for a desk, chair, monitor or similar), claimable within the first 6 months of a remote or hybrid arrangement.

A monthly connectivity stipend of $40 is paid to cover internet costs. Equipment remains company property and must be returned when employment ends.

6. Security and Confidentiality

Employees must use the company VPN when accessing internal systems from outside the office, use multi-factor authentication on all work accounts, and lock their screen when leaving their device. Company data must not be stored on personal devices or personal cloud accounts.

Work should not be done on public Wi-Fi without the VPN. Employees must report lost or stolen devices to IT security within 2 hours at security@northwind.example.

7. Performance and Review

Performance is assessed on outcomes, not hours online. Managers hold a one-to-one at least every two weeks. Northwind may change or end a remote arrangement with 30 days' notice if business needs or performance require it.